Board Meeting

October 8, 2024

National Anthem

Hudson's Bay High School Band

National Anthem
Land of 1000 Dances

Superintendent Report

Superintendent Report

- Strategic Plan Update
- Budget Development Update
- Legislative Priorities

Strategic Planning Update

OUR MISSION

Inspiring Learning.

Growing Community.

Each student, Every day.

Vision of a
Graduate
EQUITY
EQUITY
EQUITY
EQUITY
Student-Centered
Staff
Foster equitable student achievement through a diverse, skilled Staff that promotes inclusion and safety while focusing on quality instruction.
Student-Centered
Community
Bring the community together in support of our students.
Student-Centered
Experience
Create a culture of belonging and positive relationships while preparing students for the demands of their next steps through engaging curriculum, instruction, and student experiences.

Student-Centered Experience

Student-Centered Staff

GOAL: District staff will help develop and participate in rich, relevant, and meaningful professional learning that supports each student through the vision of a graduate and related policies.

Vancouver Public Schools' Teacher Leadership Academy: A Success Story!

On September 16 - 20, VPS Professional Learning team hosted a Teacher Leadership Academy for instructional coaches, learning assistance teachers, interventionists, and language development specialists. This week of transformative learning experiences focused on enhancing leadership skills, collaborative practices, and instructional excellence. Participants left with actionable strategies to elevate their impact in the classroom and beyond.

Here's what teachers said about the experience:

- *"The class on Pacific Islander culture was amazing I learned so much about how to relate to students and families".*
- *"How to support Pacific Islander students! Amplify information! Connecting with other educators around the district! Learning strategies to support and values of our Multilingual students, the WIDA assessment breakdown, and so much more!"*
- *"Knowledge of language acquisition theory and research is critical to understanding how to teach MLs. We can't expect students to complete work if we don't provide comprehensible input based on proficiency level."*
- *"Thanks for the time and space to unify all of our work. We need to be pulling this giant ship in the same direction."*

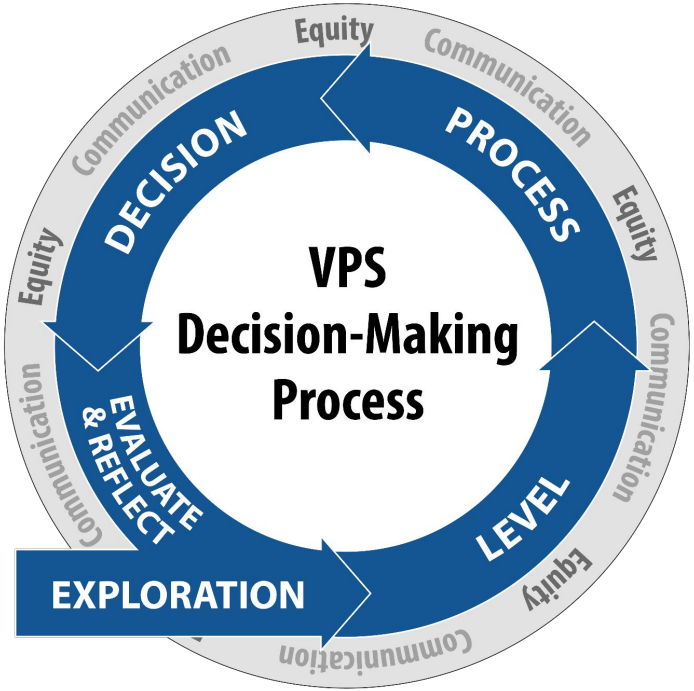
We are grateful to everyone who participated in this enriching journey of professional growth.
We are excited to see the lasting impact they'll bring to their schools and students!
#VPSLeadership #TeacherExcellence #StrongerTogether

VANCOUVER PUBLIC SCHOOLS

Budget Development

2025-26

2025-26 Budget Process



- Enrollment
- Costs
  - New certificated staff contract (VEA); implementation of new contract
  - Inflation
  - Student needs
- Revenue forecast

Levy Renewal: Feb 2025 Consideration

- Capital Levy focused on technology will expire, 12.31.25
- Sept/Oct need analysis - Safety and Tech needs
- November Resolution consideration - Board desires to balance overall school tax rate with student need
- 2.11.25 Election day

Property Taxes

Listed below are the property tax rates per thousand dollars of assessed value for the calendar years 2020-2024. The assessed value of taxable property in the district is $31.1 billion for 2024 (which is an increase in valuation of $1.9 billion from 2023).

Year	Education & Operations	Technology Levy	Bonds	Total
2020	$1.52	$0.32	$1.49	$3.33
2021	$2.01	$0.33	$1.38	$3.72
2022	$1.97	$0.32	$1.30	$3.59
2023	$1.79	$0.29	$1.14	$3.22
2024	$1.99	$0.28	$1.09	$3.36

The owner of a home valued at $500,000 for the purpose of tax assessment is anticipated to pay $1,680 in property taxes in 2024 that will go directly to Vancouver Public Schools. Property tax statements also list a "State Property Tax" that is collected by the state and distributed to school districts throughout the state of Washington according to student enrollment.

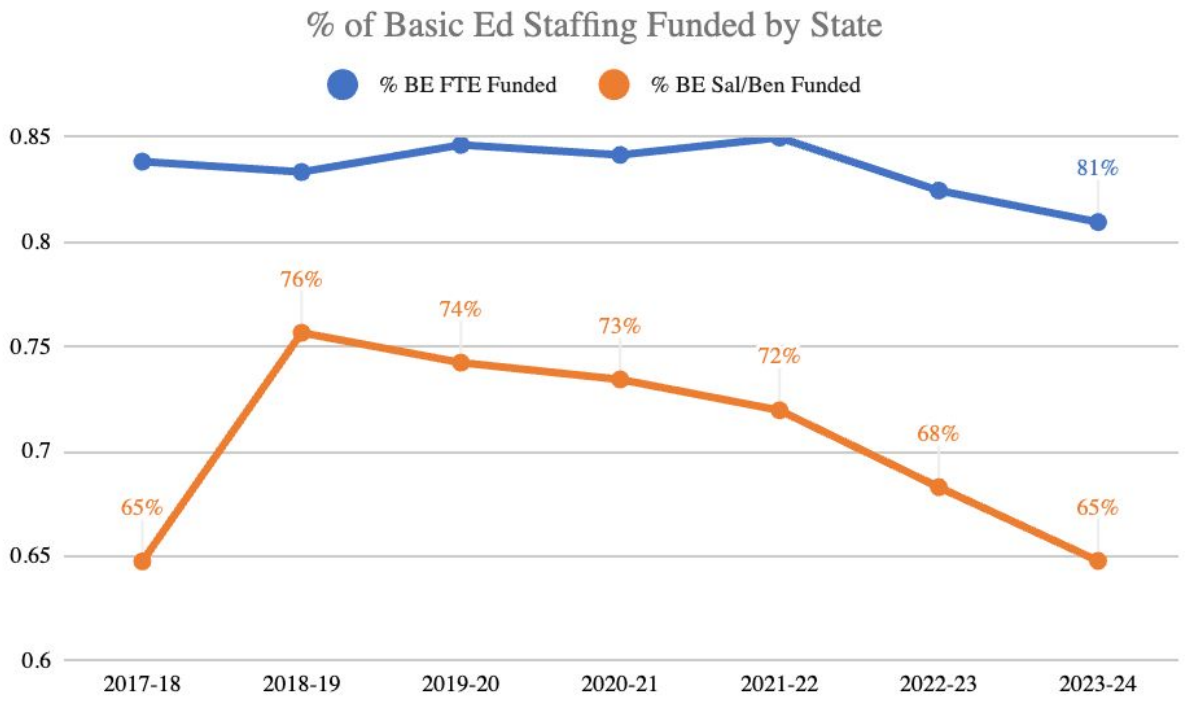
The fiscal year for Vancouver Public Schools begins September 1st and ends August 31st. Property taxes are levied and collected on a calendar year basis (January - December). The 2024-25 budget reflects a combined total of $107.7 million from the Education & Operation, Technology and Bond levies. This accounts for approximately 22% of the total district revenue in all funds. The district may not collect more taxes than the amount approved by voters. The tax rate is determined by the voter-approved levy amount divided by the assessed value.

Why was a reduction needed?

- **Increased Basic Education Staffing Costs**
  - Gap between cost per staff member and funding from state
  - Gap between # of staff needed to operate and allocation from state
- **Increased Other Costs ($20.8M)**
  - Increased Insurance and utilities costs ($1.2M more than funding received last year)
  - Special Education costs ($12.3M more than funding received last year)
  - Substitute costs ($6.7M more than funding received last year)
  - Transportation costs ($600K more than funding received last year)
- **Increased Student Need** - consistent feedback that more staff are needed
- **Student Enrollment** - overall decline since 2018

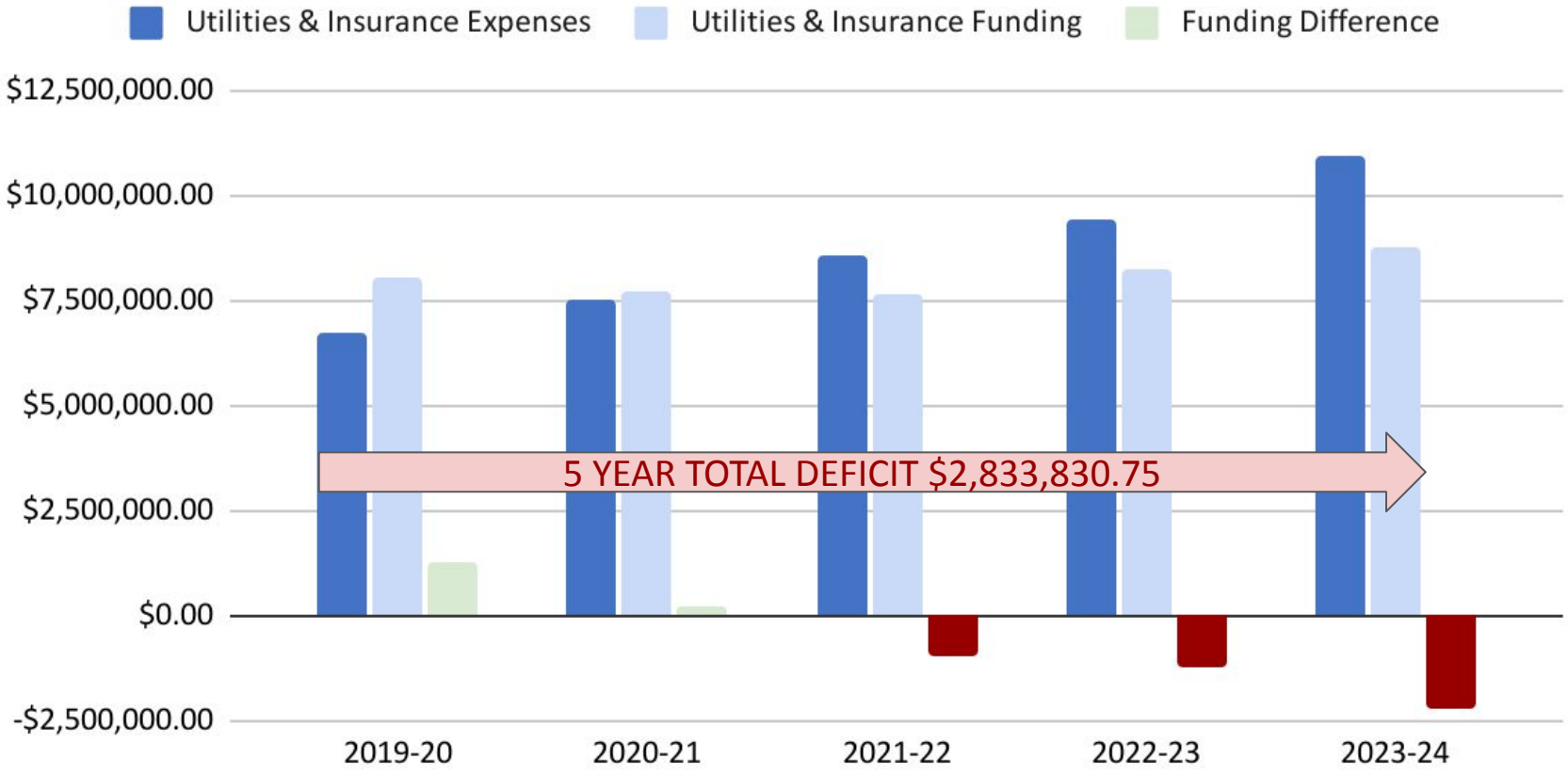
Legislative Priorities

2025 Session

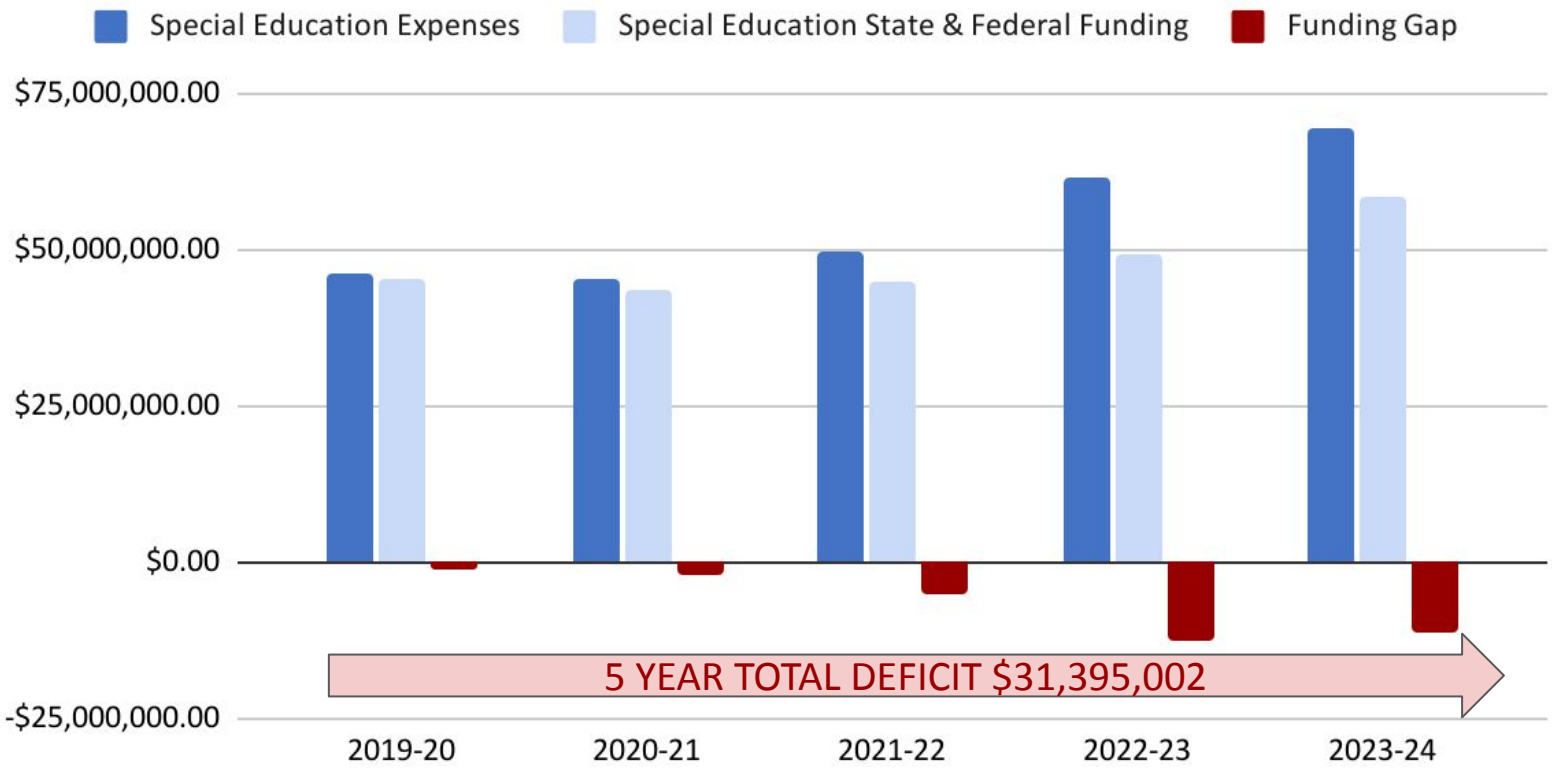


VANCOUVER PUBLIC SCHOOLS FUNDING GAP FROM THE STATE

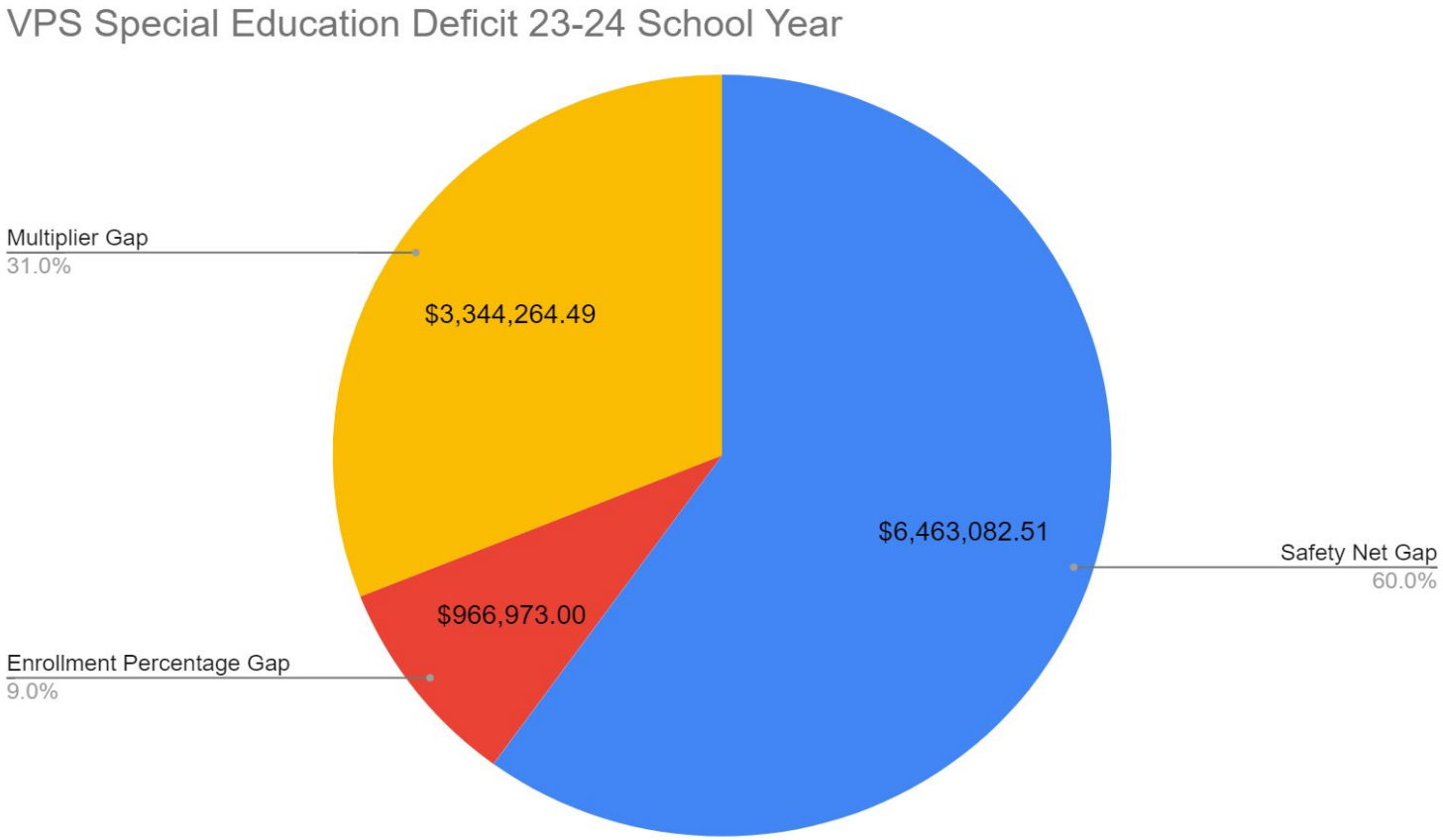
VPS: Utilities & Insurance Expenses, Utilities & Insurance Funding and Funding Difference



VPS: Special Education Expenses, Special Education State & Federal Funding and Funding Gap



What is causing the gap? Multiplier, Safety Net Gap, Enrollment Cap?



Why are we prioritizing Special Education and MSOCS

5 year trends

● Special Education	-$31,395,002
● Insurance/Utilities	-$2,833,830
	-$34,228,832

English

Issues at the Core of Washington State's School Funding Dilemma

LINK

A declining state priority. Increased student needs. Rising costs. Unfunded requirements.

These core issues are causing countless school districts across Washington to experience a financial crisis. The state of Washington is constitutionally responsible for fully funding the costs of basic education but even after reforms (the McCleary "Solution"), the state's efforts aren't keeping up with actual expenses.

VIEW VIDEOS

The state's school funding formula is the core issue.

State leaders use a funding distribution "formula" that's based on the needs of an "average school." This one-size-fits-some solution for allocating state money to schools isn't working because it doesn't recognize the unique needs and costs of

Legislative Priorities

2025 Session

2025 LEGISLATIVE PRIORITIES

Vancouver Public Schools

VANCOUVER PUBLIC SCHOOLS VPS

VPS Strategic Plan

Our Mission

Inspiring Learning.
Growing Community.
Each Student, Every Day.

Board of Directors

Kyle Sproul
Tracie Barrows
Kathy Decker
Wendy Smith
Sandra Zavala-Ortega

Superintendent

Jeff Snell, Ed.D.
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Vancouver Public Schools thanks the Legislature for their work in 2024. We appreciate their progress towards fully funding special education and enhacing the prototypical school funding model. While we acknowledge the collaboration and progress made during 2024, there are still several ongoing challenges that we ask the 2025 Legislature to address.

PRIORITY ACTION ITEMS

1 Continue to Address Special Education Funding Shortfall

In the last five years, the Legislature has increased the special education excess cost multiplier and provided additional funding for safety net awards. As we continue to include more students, these steps forward in fully funding the cost of special education are appreciated. We urge lawmakers to continue to pursue incremental and creative approaches toward fully funding special education especially as the number of students needing these services continues to increase.

ACTION REQUEST:

→ Special education is a basic education responsibility and thus we implore lawmakers to fully fund the cost of education for our most vulnerable students. Remove the funding cap, increase the per-student multiplier, and provide ample safety net funding.

2 Address Rising School Costs with Increased MSOC Funding

The 2025 Legislature must immediately address the critical underfunding of Materials, Supplies, and Operating Costs (MSOC) allocations for school districts. While staffing is our largest expense, non-staff costs, such as liability insurance, utilities, food, and fuel, have risen significantly. State MSOC funding has not kept pace with these increases, forcing us to rely on local levies to cover the gap. This limits resources for other essential priorities and undermines the ability of schools to meet the needs of our community.

ACTION REQUEST:

→ Adjust the school district MSOC funding levels in an amount that covers the actual projected MSOC costs, not the usual Implicit Price Deflator amount that has been used in the past several biennial budgets.

VANCOUVER PUBLIC SCHOOLS VPS

Inspiring Learning.
Growing Community.
Each Student, Every Day.

We advise policy-makers to:

- Continue to invest in supporting students to address their academic, mental health and social-emotional learning needs by increasing staff in the prototypical model.
- Adjust the gaps in current funding formulas in the State Construction Assistance Program, which fails to recognize the true cost of construction and/or educational space needs.
- Ensure that all K-12 education policies are enacted with a commitment to equity, excellence and innovation and a focus on the needs of the whole child.
- Support local school boards in overseeing school and district improvement efforts and meeting the unique learning needs of the students they serve.
- Provide greater flexibility of resources by limiting unfunded requirements that must be supported by local funding sources.

3 Update the Prototypical Model and Staff Allocation Formulas

Continue to make progress in updating unrealistic and outdated staff allocation formulas associated with the Prototypical School Funding Model. Funding should be aligned with the current needs of student wellness, transportation, safety and security personnel and other essential positions and funding should reflect the current job market. Even for the staff that is recognized in the limited state formulas, VPS is forced to augment salary and benefit costs by an average of 20%. We still struggle to fill essential positions. Our students deserve a professional staff.

ACTION REQUEST:

→ Increase the number of state-funded classified positions in the prototypical model to provide additional units for support staff. Paraeducators are an essential part of our school system, just like all classified staff including nutrition staff, bus drivers, office personnel, and custodians.

→ Increase pay for substitutes in the prototypical model and increase the number of days for which substitutes are funded.

4 Ensure Student Transportation is Accessible and Equitable

Under STARS, the current Pupil Transportation funding model, many districts experience significant funding gaps. We appreciate the 2022 and 2023 Legislature's provision of additional funding to address excess costs to transport special passengers; however, it is time to comprehensively fix the pupil transportation formula to ensure it is more transparent, predictable, and adequately funded.

ACTION REQUEST:

→ Allow additional types of vehicles to qualify for funding to provide more flexibility and stabilize operations, particularly for students requiring specialized transportation to accommodate disabilities indicated in students' IEP or 504 plans and for students in other protected categories, such as students experiencing homelessness and students in foster care.

Safety

- Utilize local levy and tech levy
- Increased funding for Special Ed, MSOCs, and the Prototypical Model helps us with safety

Prototypical School Model

600 average annual full-time equivalent students in grades nine through 12;
432 average annual full-time equivalent students in grades seven and eight; and
400 average annual full-time equivalent students in grades kindergarten through six.

Classified staff providing student and staff safety (includes para educators, recess, crossing guards, DROs, etc)

- Grades 9-12 = 0.141 staff members per school
- Grades 7-8 = 0.092 staff members per school
- Grades K-6 = 0.079 staff members per school

Recognition

Employee Excellence Awards

Jennifer Beeks

FCRC Coordinator

Minnehaha Elementary

Nick Hernandez

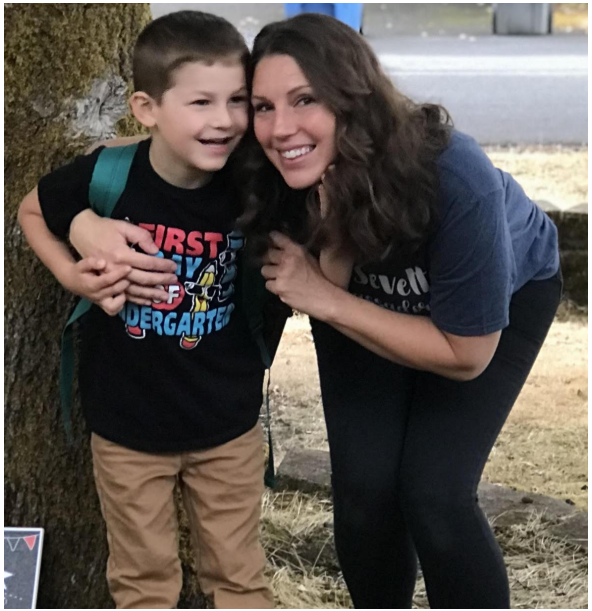
Job Facilitator

Gateway to Adult Transition Education (GATE Program)

Melissa Kurta

Paraeducator

Roosevelt Elementary



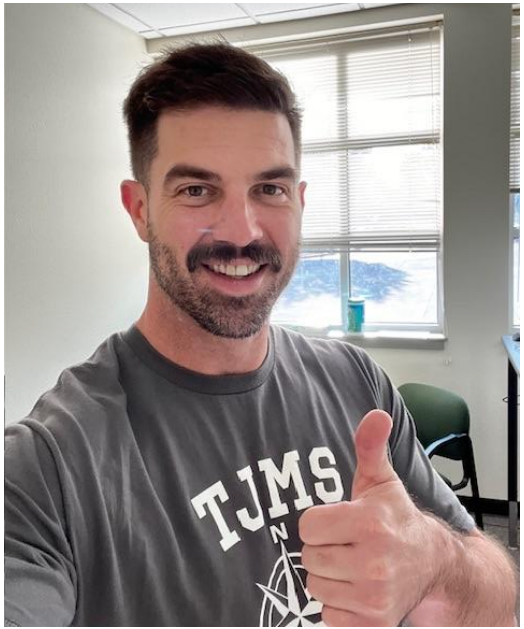
Summer Peterson

Behavior Systems Specialist

Marshall Elementary

Spencer Williams

Associate Principal

Hudson’s Bay High School

(now Thomas Jefferson Middle School)